

HUSHING

**A Creative Methodology for
Painting Place from the Inside**

Against the Picturesque: Upper Wharfedale

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Abstract

Hushing is a place-generated creative methodology, named after a historic Yorkshire Dales mining process, in which accumulated knowledge is released through decisive material action to create abstract work that carries the forces of a location without illustrating it.

A chosen place is first researched until its geology, labour, history, language, stories and bodily experience have accumulated as tacit knowledge. This knowledge is translated into an earned visual language and held like water behind a dam, waiting to be released. The sluice opens only with the First Strike: a decisive physical and material intervention on the prepared surface.

From that moment, the painting is no longer an illustration of the research. It becomes the release of its stored pressure, energy and momentum through material action.

Its three stages - Research, Visual Language and Abstraction - move from knowing, to translation, to release. Upper Wharfedale provides the first developed application and theoretical account of Hushing. A painting is complete when released force can move the painter no further. This release may last minutes or hours. Duration is not the measure; expenditure is. The result may retain exposed ground, debris, undercut edges, overflow and scattered deposits: an aftermath that is not repaired for conventional balance or finish.

Hushing is therefore not a style and not merely a metaphor for energetic painting. Its hydraulic analogy has been converted into an operational sequence: research, earned visual language, accumulation, impoundment, a place-specific preparatory ground, First Strike, release, entrainment, expenditure, deposition and aftermath. Each term identifies a condition, action or threshold within the making process. The sequence can transfer to another place, but its visual outcome cannot be prescribed because place, history, materials and the painter's encounter must alter the process. Situated within the British tradition of place-derived abstraction, particularly the St Ives lineage, Hushing proposes that process rather than resemblance can become the principal carrier of place. In Hushing, place is causally rather than necessarily pictorially present: it determines the conditions through which the painting is made, even when a viewer cannot identify the location from its surface. The painting reaches material completion at deposition; in encounter, however, the viewer may undergo an analogous personal Hushing by suspending inherited expectations of landscape depiction and trusting their own response to the forces materially present in the work.

RESEARCH	EARNED LANGUAGE	RELEASE	AFTERMATH
Accumulation and embodied encounter	Translation and impoundment	First Strike, pressure and entrainment	Expenditure, deposition and no repair

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Against the Picturesque

Before the first visit, before the first mark, a landscape painter working within inherited British pastoral and Picturesque traditions should understand how particular conventions within those traditions have served ownership, concealed labour, aestheticised hardship and made dispossession beautiful. The argument is historically specific: it concerns the social work performed by identifiable conventions and institutions, not an accusation that every figurative landscape repeats them. This remains essential background knowledge within Hushing. A painter who enters this inheritance without examining it may still reproduce an apparatus of possession and hierarchy, whether they intend to or not. To paint Upper Wharfedale through Hushing, the painter must first know what this practice is painting against.

The British Picturesque tradition - Gilpin's tours, Price's aesthetics and the gentleman's framing of country as scenery - frequently operated as a proprietary act. It could transform common land into a view, living labour into atmosphere and human hardship into charm. The farmer's field became a compositional device. The weaver's mill became a ruin worth painting. The working body was often diminished or contained; the pleasing prospect remained.

Barrell (1980) traces this management of rural labour in eighteenth- and early nineteenth-century English painting. The rural poor are often marginalised, idealised or rendered as picturesque incident - decorative, passive and unthreatening. The suffering was real; its representation was managed. A labourer placed in the foreground could remain furniture within a stage set organised around the interests of ownership rather than the worker.

Williams (1973, pp. 9-12) approached the problem through literature. His 'escalator' describes the recurring backward movement of rural nostalgia: each generation locates an authentic country order in an earlier time, only to find that earlier writers had already declared it lost. That recurring retrospect can naturalise the present landscape and obscure the changing histories of labour, enclosure and ownership through which it was made. The view becomes heritage while its conflicts recede from sight.

Berger (1972) sharpened the relationship between European oil painting and possession: painting often displayed what could be owned. Landscape was no exception. The country-house portrait, the pastoral view and the Picturesque tour could confirm the right of some people to possess what others worked. To paint against the Picturesque is to resist that confirmation. It is to insist that these hills also carry the people who broke themselves on them, not only those who passed through with a Claude glass held up to admire the framing.

Mitchell (1994, pp. 1-2) proposes landscape not simply as a genre but as a medium: a cultural practice through which constructed social relations can appear natural and historical arrangements can appear eternal. The Picturesque may confirm hierarchy by making it look like scenery. Hushing's counter-move is to make those relations active again, to refuse the consumable view and to insist on the work that produced the ground.

Within Hushing, the formal response to this counter-claim is abstraction - not merely as a matter of personal preference, but as a methodological consequence. This is not an indictment of figurative landscape painting as such. Figurative and representational practices can expose labour, dispossession, ecology and contested ownership with great force. The narrower claim is that any landscape painting risks repeating the Picturesque when it organises place primarily as a consumable prospect: a view framed from a stable position, with labour and conflict subordinated to visual coherence. Hushing chooses abstraction because its own method seeks to interrupt that particular relation of distance and possession. It is one situated counter-move, not the only ethical form available.

This produces a familiar question for abstract landscape: if a painting does not look like Wharfedale, in what sense can it be a painting of Wharfedale? Hushing refuses resemblance as the principal carrier of place. Instead, place is carried through process. Geology may enter through drag, abrasion, flow, accumulation and deposition; labour through bodily effort and material handling; history through accumulated pressure rather than depicted incident. The work can therefore remain abstract while being specifically generated by the place from which

it arose. Put differently, Wharfedale determines how the painting happens rather than simply what it depicts.

Abstraction does not become a working-class counter-position merely by being non-figurative. It has its own histories of institutional authority, specialist language, market value and exclusion. If Hushing simply replaced the gentleman's privileged view with an equally privileged abstract code, it would reproduce the hierarchy it claims to resist.

What distinguishes Hushing's abstraction is therefore procedural rather than stylistic: sustained research; material conditions generated by the place; bodily labour; a documented chain from encounter to release; and a refusal to prescribe the viewer's correct response. Its working-class counter-claim lies in what it centres and how it is made - workers, contested histories, earned knowledge, physical effort and material consequence - not in any claim that abstract form is inherently democratic. Abstraction remains resistant only while it is accountable to place, labour, material, process and encounter.

Schapiro (1937) argued that abstract work carries social meaning through, rather than despite, its formal properties. Colour, mark, surface and texture are not necessarily evasions of content: they can register a body acting purposefully on material. Clark (1999) provides a further account of modernist painting struggling to make its conditions and contradictions visible in the work, while Fuller's materialist and Ruskinian criticism (1988) offers a context for insisting that painting remain grounded in body, medium and nature. These references are structural pressures within Hushing, not authorities that prescribe what the finished painting must look like.

To absorb the political history of the British landscape traditions inherited by this project - their class functions, conventions and refusals - is as necessary a preparation as knowing the geology of a place, the history of its people or the behaviour of its materials. Political knowledge, geological knowledge and local knowledge belong to the same stage of preparation. All must be inside the painter before the decisive intervention begins. Hushing gathers these streams of knowledge, translates them into an earned visual language, holds them until they become tacit and finally releases them as force in the act of making. The practice that follows is built on this politics; it does not leave it behind.

Stage One: Research

A landscape painter begins by choosing a location, often drawn by a view or curiosity about its history. Something in the environment engages the eye and stimulates the imagination, creating a desire to know more. I have travelled to Upper Wharfedale many times over the years, though I have often resisted making an isolated response due to time or other projects. A single painting made from a passing encounter may possess aesthetic value, but it risks carrying too little of the place's history, labour and material complexity. Hushing therefore begins with sustained attention rather than immediate representation.

That attention develops through research into the location's history, customs, geography and stories. Such work requires time, commitment, resources and expense, all frequently undervalued as contributions to a project, particularly when the painter lives more than eighty miles away. The itinerant artist who follows only the pull of the visual risks working from the surface of things. Like a pothole or a fissure in limestone, a small opening can reveal depths that were always present but not immediately visible.

Hushing sits in productive relation to several established ways of knowing while remaining methodologically distinct. It has an affinity with grounded research (Glaser and Strauss, 1967) through its inductive accumulation of knowledge from sustained enquiry rather than from a predetermined visual conclusion; an affinity with ethnography (Pink, 2015) through fieldwork, observation, conversation, situated encounter and reflexive awareness; and an affinity with phenomenology (Merleau-Ponty, 2012) through its recognition of bodily, sensory and lived experience as valid sources of knowledge. Tacit knowledge (Polanyi, 1966) provides theoretical support for the point at which accumulated research becomes internalised and

capable of informing responsive material action. Hushing itself remains the distinct methodology: it draws from these established ways of knowing but proposes a specific process for converting accumulated knowledge of place into abstract painting through earned visual language, impoundment, First Strike, release, deposition and aftermath.

Research begins with desk-based enquiry: literature and web searches, books, maps, films and drawings. Notes and annotations in the sketchbook begin to map the imagined space. Fieldwork follows through planned walks, visits to pubs where local images are displayed, and conversations with farmers, residents and visitors. Each encounter opens further lines of enquiry, builds context and gradually deepens the painter's understanding of place.

Visits should be seasonal, allowing the painter to experience changes in light, storms that obscure the view, intense summer heat and frozen cheekbones on a winter's day. Over time the research takes hold of the imagination. Kilnsey Crag returns to me while I sit in the studio or talk with friends. The place is no longer confined to the visit.

In the landscape I start to gather materials. I store river water in five-gallon containers. I pick up rocks and scratch marks into the ground. I am preparing, through ritual, for the start of the material phase. I often stand and look - observing features, identifying topography and stratigraphy, and connecting reference points seen on a map. I watch the farmer tend a flock enclosed by dry-stone walls that follow contours formed through sedimentation, uplift, faulting, glaciation and erosion. This activates a physical response and spatial connection to the landscape. The body becomes a primary instrument of enquiry: to feel scale shift as cloud moves across the fell, to hear a change in the river before seeing it, or to feel the cold of limestone through the hand is a form of data. It cannot be retrieved from a map or book. It has to be earned in the body, on site, in weather.

The first material ground of each painting is laid down with water collected from the River Wharfe. The water may carry dissolved ions and trace constituents, together with suspended mineral and organic matter from its catchment, and it alters the paper through wetting, staining, deposition and changes in absorbency. Without analysis, the precise chemistry or mineral phases present in any particular sample are not presumed. The claim is narrower and more material: water from the place physically conditions the surface before the artist's hand enters. The landscape makes the prior mark.

This is a material condition, not a claim that the water deposits a predetermined pigment. Upper Wharfedale belongs to a Carboniferous sequence of limestone, Yoredale cyclothem and Millstone Grit, with mineralised veins and a long history of lead extraction in parts of the district (Dunham and Wilson, 1985). The paper holds what the collected water materially carried and the traces shaped by its movement. In Upper Wharfedale, impoundment takes material form as river-ground: it prepares and conditions the field of action. River-ground is a place-specific device rather than a universal requirement of Hushing; another location must generate its own preparatory material condition. It is not the First Strike. The sluice opens later, with the painter's first decisive intervention on that prepared surface. Deep time is not merely the theme of these paintings; it participates in their material preparation.

Deep Geological Time: Water and Trace Material

The River Wharfe does not carry geological time as an image. It carries the consequences of contact. Rain and groundwater move across and through soils, limestone, gritstone and mineralised structures before joining the river. In doing so, water may acquire dissolved ions and trace constituents, together with suspended particles derived from erosion and human activity. The collected water therefore arrives at the paper as water that has encountered the catchment, not as a chemically neutral studio medium.

This material connection must be stated with precision. Without chemical analysis, Hushing does not claim that a particular sample contains identifiable quantities of lead, iron, calcium or any other named element, nor that it deposits a visible geological pigment. Minerals as crystalline solids are not simply transferred intact by metaphor: some constituents may be

dissolved as ions, while fine mineral and organic particles may remain suspended. The defensible claim is that place-specific water carries a variable trace history of what it has flowed over, through and around.

Deep geological time therefore enters Hushing in two related ways. It is known through the formation, uplift, mineralisation, glaciation and erosion of the dale; and it is materially approached through water whose present movement continues those much longer processes of dissolution, transport and deposition. When that water wets, stains and alters the absorbency of the support, ancient geology is not illustrated. Its continuing afterlife helps condition the field on which the First Strike will occur. The trace may be modest in quantity, but it is significant in method: before the painter releases accumulated knowledge, the catchment has already acted upon the surface.

Ruskin's sustained attention to the geological structure of mountains in *Modern Painters* (1843-1860) established geological knowledge as a serious condition of landscape observation. That scientific, physical and earned rigour is a working principle here. The difference is that Ruskin's geological attention often remained in service of the Sublime. Within Hushing, geology is not organised into a spectacle for distant contemplation. It is ordinary, ancestral and materially implicated in the ground and marks.

The narratives gathered from farmers, weavers, miners, builders, peasants and tradesmen inevitably provoke conflicting emotions, influencing what I select and how I proceed. I see nothing romantic in using the landscape to service an intellectualised vision of the Sublime, particularly where that vision reinforces religious dogma or class division. My working-class background is present in this research as a lens: it determines what I look for and what I refuse to look away from. The research is not neutral, nor is it intended to be. By the end of Stage One the painter should know the place: its geology, labour history, stories and wounds. This knowledge, held alongside the political understanding established before the first visit, becomes the foundation of the visual language developed in Stage Two.

Stage Two: Visual Language

Stage Two develops a visual language from the colours, minerals, stories, myths, people, customs, culture and history of the specific place. These become annotated notes in colour and text. Colour is not merely decorative. Ochres can derive from or refer to iron oxides; greens may recall malachite, verdigris or vegetation; greys carry the memory of lead workings, limestone and millstone dust. Some materials are physically gathered; others are interpretive translations. The palette does not claim chemical identity without evidence. Its task is to convert encountered geology and labour history into an earned rather than generic visual vocabulary.

Ingold's concept of the taskscape offers a useful framework: landscape is not static scenery but the accumulated trace of human labour and dwelling over time (Ingold, 1993). The packman's route worn into limestone, the mill race cut by hand and the boundary following a pre-enclosure strip are not merely Picturesque details. They are labour made legible. To read and translate them into visual language is to move through landscape by wayfaring rather than to survey it from above (Ingold, 2007).

The annotations made at this stage are the bridge between knowing and making: place names, occupations, geological strata and fragments of oral record. They are not labels on a finished work but a form of thinking aloud - the research still wet and active before it is consumed by the painting. By the end of Stage Two the painter has a palette that is specific rather than generic, earned rather than arbitrary, and grounded in sustained encounter rather than aesthetic convention.

Representation as Frame and Foil: Field Studies and Studio Release

Hushing does not require the painter to deny beauty as a source of inspiration. Nor can the painter deny their own sensibilities, education and history as lenses through which landscape is encountered. These influences are not neutral, but neither are they treated as defects that can simply be removed. They belong to the accumulated psychological and art-historical pressures through which the work begins.

The Picturesque is therefore not only an external tradition against which Hushing declares itself. It may already be present within the painter's habits of looking, selecting, framing and composing. A traditional watercolour made in the landscape can be a sincere response to beauty, atmosphere and visual order. Such a study is not invalidated because it uses an inherited language. It records one stage of the encounter and makes that inheritance visible.

The study consequently operates both as frame and as foil. It frames the landscape as a view: selecting where the place begins and ends and organising it through the painter's sensibility. At the same time, it becomes a foil against which further knowledge can exert pressure. Geology, labour, ownership, language, memory, weather and bodily experience may complicate what the beautiful view initially appeared to contain. Hushing begins by recognising beauty's attraction while refusing to allow beauty to become the final or complete account of place.

Observational drawings, traditional or Picturesque watercolours and mixed-media studies may therefore belong to Stages One and Two. They gather colour, structure, movement, material behaviour and immediate sensation. Some may remain complete works in their own right; others may be annotated, altered or retained as evidence of the developing visual language. They are not required to predict the final painting and should not become small compositional plans for later enlargement. Their purpose is enquiry, accumulation and translation.

The movement from field study to studio painting marks a change in function rather than a change from truth to invention. In the field, the painter encounters, observes and gathers. In the studio, that knowledge is carried through memory, material, study and bodily experience until it can operate tacitly. The larger oil painting does not reproduce, simplify or enlarge the watercolour. Once the First Strike occurs, the authority of the study is placed under pressure alongside the painter's other inherited expectations. The watercolour gathers the view; Hushing releases what the view cannot contain.

Oil paint is particularly capable of sustaining this release through its weight, viscosity, drag, resistance and duration. It does not simply receive the painter's action: it acts back, slowing, obstructing and redirecting the mark. It can accumulate into ridges and deposits, be scraped or displaced, and retain earlier actions as buried strata. These qualities allow the studio work to register flow encountering resistance rather than merely illustrating energy or reproducing the appearance of geological process.

Hushing may take place directly within the landscape, within a temporary studio close to it, or later in the painter's permanent studio. A temporary working space might be a hired room, church hall, hostel or other provisional studio. Such proximity allows the encounter to remain immediate: the painter continues to experience the weather, journeys, people and atmosphere of the place while gaining a different degree of separation from the visible prospect.

When working outdoors, I may deliberately turn away from the view. I remain physically inside the landscape, exposed to its wind, temperature, sound, weather, scale and bodily pressures, but the prospect itself is no longer positioned before me as an image to be copied or compositionally organised. This is not a refusal to look. Sustained looking, drawing and study have already taken place. Turning away transfers attention from the appearance of the landscape to the marks, materials, resistance and emerging necessities of the painting. The place continues to act upon the body and the work while the view is prevented from supervising the release.

Turning away from the view does not remove the painter from the landscape; it removes the landscape's appearance from authority over the painting. Work made in the permanent studio poses a related but different test: whether the place has been sufficiently accumulated and internalised to remain causally present after physical proximity has also been removed. The location and orientation of production alter the pressures within Hushing, but do not alone determine the work's authenticity.

Hushing is therefore not abstraction imposed upon a place from the outset. It is abstraction reached through sustained encounter, representation, knowledge and eventual material release. The framed view is neither denied nor permitted to govern the aftermath. Beauty initiates the encounter, but it does not determine where the painting must come to rest.

The Painting as a Manifestation of Earned Knowledge

The resulting abstract painting is strengthened by everything accumulated before its release. Through sustained encounter, research, representation, memory and material action, the painter moves beyond the visible prospect and reconstitutes the landscape through creative and intellectual understanding. The painting does not merely illustrate knowledge of place; it becomes a visual and material manifestation of that knowledge. It adds another layer to our understanding of landscape and bears witness to the effects that place, history and memory exert upon both painter and viewer.

Abstraction does not diminish the landscape. When earned through knowledge and encounter, it enlarges what the landscape can mean to people, to communities and to society.

Geographical Scope

Upper Wharfedale is the central field area of this first developed application and theoretical account. Adjacent sites such as Gaping Gill, Stump Cross, Greenhow and the Strid may appear as comparative Yorkshire Dales or River Wharfe references; they are not presented as locations within Upper Wharfedale. Their function is to extend a specific line of geological, industrial or legendary enquiry without dissolving the geographic centre of the project.

The Elemental Body: Process, Labour, and Legend

This valley was not always here. What I stand inside when I work in Wharfedale - the arc of the dale, its limestone walls and gill-cut flanks, the river running its current course - is the residue of forces so protracted and so violent that the human timescale is barely adequate to acknowledge them. When I try to carry this landscape into the work, I am not trying to represent it. I am trying to work through the processes that made it.

I think about what shaped this place. In the Carboniferous seas, carbonate mud and the accumulated remains of marine organisms were deposited, compacted and cemented into limestone over geological time. This is layering: a foundational action of both geology and painting. When I build a surface across multiple sessions, returning to it, adding and partially concealing, I work through an analogous logic. Each stratum records what preceded it. The limestone face of Kilnsey Crag is a document of compressed time, read vertically. I read it as I read a worked painting surface - looking for what earlier events left and what came later to alter them.

The glaciers worked differently, and I feel the difference in the body. They scraped, gouged and dragged. The Devensian ice sheet that moved through this valley carried embedded rock fragments that scored the bedrock in long striations, marks made by sustained force until the surface yielded. When I drag a loaded brush across resistant paper with full-arm pressure, I work through analogous material principles: direction, sustained pressure, resistance and displacement. Material moves under force and form emerges through action rather than illustration. The marks left on exposed limestone by glacial movement record that process. So does the painting.

I collect river water and carry it back to the field studio. As it moves across a surface, finding the gradient, pooling where the current slackens and leaving watermarks at the edge of each deposit, I watch the Wharfe's logic operate at a different scale. The river cuts at the outside of bends, deposits on the inside, undercuts banks until they collapse, carries material in suspension and sets it down wherever the force gives out. The floodplain is this deposition made durable: a record of successive floods laid in strata. I work with that process when I allow the collected river water to condition the surface before my hand enters. The landscape has already acted. I arrive later.

Caves across the Yorkshire Dales offer a different understanding of fissure. Vertical joints intersect horizontal bedding planes to create routes that water follows and enlarges over time. At the surface, clints and grykes form another articulated field through the dissolution of limestone along existing weaknesses. A cave wall is stratigraphy made interior. It shows me what a layered painting is trying to do.

Wind I understand first through the skin. Its importance here is bodily and material rather than a claim that it is the primary geomorphic force in Upper Wharfedale. Exposure changes temperature, balance, drying time, attention and the behaviour of wet material. In the work, the relevant distinction is between a surface acted upon by sustained directional pressure and a surface held in reserve. Heavily worked passages and untouched ground make one another visible.

Human labour enters this landscape as a continuation of material process, not an interruption of it. Dry-stone walls use stone cleared from fields, gathered locally or quarried nearby, held without mortar through gravity, friction and the reading of form. The waller works through embodied knowledge: looking for what fits the gap, what will bed flat and what will bridge the

courses below. The knowledge is in the hands and cannot be fully articulated in advance of action. The resulting wall draws across the landscape while following contours formed by earlier geological forces.

I understand weaving through the same logic as stratigraphy. The wool trade that shaped the economy of these dales, from fell flocks and domestic handlooms to the mills, is a process of accumulation: warp and weft interlace, and the surface is produced through their repeated crossing. No individual thread carries the strength; the structure does. In a painting built through successive layers, earlier work is neither erased nor dominant. It remains structurally present, altered by what follows and altering what comes after. I am weaving in a different material.

Hushing: Accumulation and Release

The lead workings of Wharfedale - including Grassington Moor and Hebden - show what it means to read a landscape from the inside. Across the wider Yorkshire Dales, historic hushing impounded water and released it as a controlled torrent to strip overburden and reveal or exploit mineral veins (Historic England, n.d.-b; Yorkshire Dales National Park Authority, n.d.-b). The name of this methodology is drawn from that regional working process. It does not collapse every rake, leat, dam, drainage channel or mine scar into a hush; those historical distinctions remain important. In painting, the operational logic is specific: research accumulates pressure; visual language gives it material form; the prepared surface holds it in reserve; release converts accumulated knowledge into action; and the work reaches completion through expenditure and deposition, leaving the aftermath unrepaired. The analogy is tested by what it makes the painter do. I am not illustrating a hush. I am working through its logic.

I notice the smaller processes too, those without grand geological scale. A tree falls across a beck; debris accumulates behind it; a pool forms; a water meadow begins. No event predetermined the next, but each created the conditions for what followed. The shadow of a cloud changes the colour of the fell, shifts it from warm to cold, reorders distance and makes familiar ground temporarily strange. Colour here is not a fixed property of the surface but a relationship between surface and light at a specific moment. In the field the reference is always moving, and each mark responds to ground that has already changed. Painting becomes a response to an event rather than the capture of a fixed thing.

Norse-derived vocabulary remains active in the mapped landscape: gill, beck, scar and thwaite name features and settlements through the practical language of navigation and dwelling (Smith, 1961-1963). These words are not decorative additions to place. They are inherited tools for distinguishing what matters within it. A scar names exposed rock and, in modern English, also carries the sense of a wound. Hushing permits that later resonance without pretending that the historical meanings are identical.

The region was inhabited long before its present maps and boundaries, including by communities associated with the Brigantes. Their beliefs cannot be reconstructed here as fact. What I can acknowledge is a disposition of place - a felt character sometimes described through the later term *genius loci*. Within Hushing this is not evidence of supernatural agency. It names the way a location acts psychologically upon the person who enters it: a register that is encountered before it is fully interpreted.

As a comparative River Wharfe event, the Strid narrows into a deep, turbulent channel whose surface width conceals the force beneath. The legend of young Romilly, his drowning and his mother's grief, was preserved in Wordsworth's *The Force of Prayer* (1815). To know the story is to know something that topographical observation alone cannot supply. The painting must carry the gap between visible surface and concealed force - not as illustration, but as pressure.

The Harrying of the North in 1069-1070 forms another historical pressure within this project. Norman devastation, dispossession and the recording of extensive waste in northern England belong to the political history through which the region was reordered (Kapelle, 1979). Hushing does not claim that this single event alone produced the present appearance of the

high fells; later pastoral economies, mining, enclosure and settlement also transformed the land. The Harrying enters the work as one compressed historical wound beneath a surface too easily received as timeless heritage.

When I carry all of this - geological process, human labour, the mythological character of specific places and the historical violence beneath the scenic surface - into the act of making, I am not illustrating any of it. I bring it to the threshold at which knowledge becomes force. It is held there like impounded water. Stage Three begins when the sluice opens, often prompted by a sense of urgency: a desire to make sense of the accumulated knowledge, release its stored energy and clear space for new ideas generated by new locations. This clearing is not a fourth stage of Hushing but a consequence of release: when one body of accumulated knowledge reaches deposition, another location can begin a new cycle of accumulation.

Stage Three: Abstraction

Stage Three begins when continuous verbal and conceptual supervision of the research is relinquished. Conscious judgement remains active, but the research now operates tacitly through material decisions. Polanyi calls this tacit knowledge: the dimension of understanding that cannot be fully articulated and that exists in the body and hand as well as in conscious formulation. 'We can know more than we can tell' (Polanyi, 1966, p. 4). Research accumulates until it can enter gesture as tacit knowledge. This is not mysticism. It is craft: the condition skilled practice reaches when technique and knowledge are sufficiently internalised to become responsive action.

The body's felt encounter with landscape is likewise phenomenological: sensation, movement and orientation are valid sources of situated knowledge and, once internalised, can catalyse the First Strike.

Sedimentation and cementation, glacial abrasion and displacement, and the river's persistence and erosion are the original mark-making processes of this place. Stage Three works through their analogous material principles rather than depicting their appearance.

When the brush or tool first strikes the prepared surface with decisive force, it opens the sluice. The earlier river-ground belongs to preparation and impoundment; it has conditioned the surface but has not initiated the release. The First Strike is the painter's first committed material intervention within the painting proper. From that point, subsequent marks work through pressure, resistance, displacement, flow, accumulation and release. Pigment across a wet surface follows gradient; a loaded brush dragged across grain responds to resistance. The painter does not imitate geological appearance. The painter continues material process at another scale.

Conscious Judgement Within the Release

Hushing does not require unconscious painting or the abandonment of skill. The painter still sees, chooses, responds and acts. The distinction is between judgement operating inside an active material encounter and judgement imposed from outside it to make the image conform to a predetermined idea of balance, beauty or finish. A deliberate mark can belong to Hushing when it arises from pressure, resistance, momentum or necessity within the release. What the method resists is external supervision that repairs the event into a composition.

Entrainment: The Painter Inside the Release

The first strike does more than release the accumulated pressure of research, memory and place: it entrains the painter within that release. From this point the painter no longer treats the process as fully controllable. The painter moves within it like a boulder caught in the sediment-laden rush of a hushing stream - rolled, accelerated, redirected, obstructed and carried according to the force acting upon it.

Once the sluice is opened, it is not closed simply because the painter dislikes where the flow is going. The painter may redirect the work in response to material resistance or emerging necessity, but does not impose a more satisfactory composition from outside the encounter. To

do so would restore the supervisory position Hushing relinquishes. The painter moves with the force until it can move them no further.

The released energy may dissipate, or the painter may become lodged within the event like a boulder deposited in a riverbed. Energy may remain elsewhere in the system, but the particular body caught within it has reached rest. This is the point of completion. Deposition is not simply a new name for personal satisfaction: it is tested by the quality of the next possible action. The aftermath remains.

Practical Test for Deposition

Before declaring the event complete, the painter asks three questions. They do not convert deposition into a mechanical rule; they distinguish active necessity from retrospective repair.

- Is the next mark demanded by the active material encounter, or merely by dissatisfaction with how the image looks?
- Has movement become repetitive, decorative or explanatory rather than necessary?
- Would another mark continue the release, or begin repairing and organising its consequences?

A pause is not deposition. Work may continue across sessions when the next action remains demanded by the same release; returning after deposition solely to improve the image constitutes repair.

Material Pressures

Every medium and every substrate has its own material friction. Oil paint, watercolour and pastel possess inherent behaviours - viscosity, flow, staining, opacity, drag, absorbency, granulation, resistance, smudging, drying and the capacity to pool, bleed, scrape or break across a surface. These qualities are not technical inconveniences to be overcome. Within Hushing they are active pressures within the event and can be exploited as part of both the creative process and its aesthetic.

Those pressures change according to circumstance. A medium behaves differently in the field and in the studio, in heat, cold, wind or damp, on wet paper, rough canvas, primed board or another resistant ground. The surface may absorb or repel; pigment may drag, flood, stain, clot or disperse; a brush may catch, skip or unload unexpectedly. Hushing incorporates these contingencies rather than correcting them away. The painter works with material friction as they work with gradient, gravity and current: as a force that can redirect the course of the release.

The medium is therefore not a neutral carrier of the painter's intention. It can accelerate, slow, obstruct, divert and deposit the mark. Material pressure acts upon the painter at the same time that the painter acts upon the material. A thin wash, a broken passage, a dragged edge, a flooded stain or an abraded surface may remain because each records the encounter between force, medium and substrate. To regularise those effects afterwards for the sake of consistency or conventional finish would be another form of repair. Within Hushing, the material is allowed to keep the evidence of its own resistance.

Material Range: Oil, Acrylic and Mixed Media

Hushing is not dependent upon a single painting medium. Oil paint, acrylic, ink, pastel, pencil and other mixed media may all participate in the release. Their differing physical properties allow the painting to register different speeds, densities, pressures and durations of material action.

Acrylic can stain, flood, run and settle rapidly, allowing the initial release to move across the support with something of the immediacy of water passing over ground. Oil paint introduces a different temporal and material register: viscosity, drag, weight, suspension and slower deposition. It can remain mobile long after the first intervention, allowing the released energy to continue to shift, accumulate and settle.

Ink can seep, bleed and migrate through the surface, recalling processes of saturation, drainage and capillary movement. Pastel can sit as dry deposit, dust or residue, while pencil can scratch, score, map and interrupt the surface with a more linear and forensic register. These marks may evoke traces, boundaries, strata, paths, field systems or geological fractures without becoming descriptive illustrations of them.

The materials are not employed to imitate geological formations or landscape effects. Rather, their behaviours become material equivalents for processes already encountered in the landscape: erosion, deposition, seepage, accumulation, saturation, abrasion, fracture and sedimentation. In this sense, the painting does not describe the landscape from a distance. It allows analogous physical processes to occur within the material body of the work.

Mixed media therefore extends the language of Hushing. Each material carries its own resistance, speed and capacity for release, allowing the painting to move between fluidity and dryness, density and transparency, incision and deposit. What unifies the work is not the choice of medium but the underlying sequence of accumulation, strike, release, deposition and exhaustion.

Psychological Pressures: Inner State and the Mood of Place

The pressures within Hushing are not only geological, historical, bodily or material. The painter also brings a psychological state to the encounter. Memory, anxiety, grief, anger, confidence, excitement, fatigue, anticipation or calm can alter attention, risk, pace and physical action. These inner conditions are not noise to be eliminated in pursuit of an objective landscape. They form part of the pressure accumulated behind the sluice.

Place can also act psychologically upon the painter. A landscape may be beautiful and yet oppressive, threatening, overpowering or immense. A valley can enclose; a crag can dominate; an open moor can expose the body to an unsettling scale. Weather, darkness, silence, wind, isolation, geological mass and historical knowledge can produce melancholy, fear, exhilaration, awe or a sense of spiritual presence. These states are not separate from the encounter with landscape. They are part of what the place does to the person who enters it.

Hushing allows these psychological states to affect the release without converting them into predetermined symbols. Anger does not require a red mark, fear a dark passage or spirituality an illuminated horizon. Such translation would turn emotion back into illustration. Instead, psychological pressure may alter pace, force, hesitation, repetition, risk, restraint, scale or duration. The state of mind enters the painting as pressure and changes the way the painter is carried within the release.

This also allows Hushing to acknowledge the experience of the sublime without returning automatically to the Sublime as a pictorial convention. A landscape can genuinely produce awe, fear, transcendence or spiritual intensity; the painter can feel overwhelmed by scale or momentarily insignificant within geological time. What Hushing resists is the later organisation of that experience into a conventionally Sublime image designed to reproduce awe for the spectator. The experience may enter the painting as pressure without becoming spectacle.

Art-Historical Pressure: History as Foil

The history of landscape painting also exerts pressure upon the act of making. The painter does not arrive at a place without an inheritance. The Picturesque, the pastoral, the Sublime, Romantic landscape, realism, modernism and abstraction have already established ways of framing, ordering, idealising, possessing, resisting and refusing landscape. That history enters Hushing as another accumulated layer.

This inheritance can excite the painter, provoke resistance, create doubt or actively undermine the process. It can operate as a foil: something against which the painter pushes, tests, contradicts or occasionally discovers an unexpected affinity. To take on history as a foil is not necessarily to quote an earlier painting or imitate an established style. The pressure comes

from knowing that the act of painting landscape already has a history and allowing that knowledge to sharpen, trouble or energise the present encounter.

Art history, however, cannot become another supervisor once the sluice has opened. If marks are arranged to demonstrate opposition to the Picturesque, reproduce the Sublime or prove allegiance to abstraction, historical knowledge has become prescription. Within Hushing, that history belongs first to accumulation: it is researched, absorbed and internalised until it can enter the release as tacit pressure rather than a checklist of references. It may redirect the current, but cannot dictate where the painting must come to rest.

At this point five pressures are acting together: the accumulated pressure of place; the bodily pressure of the painter; the material pressure of medium and substrate; the psychological pressure arising both from the painter's inner state and from the mood of the place; and the art-historical pressure of inherited landscape conventions. These pressures are porous rather than separate. Weather can alter the body and the mind; material resistance can change confidence or aggression; historical knowledge can sharpen refusal or produce hesitation; place can act upon all of them. None is passive and none has complete control. Hushing takes place in the negotiation between these interacting pressures. The painting is not the execution of an image already possessed by the painter; it is the material record of place, body, mind, material and history meeting, resisting, redirecting and eventually coming to rest.

A Bounded Use of Pressure

Pressure operates in two explicitly different registers within Hushing. In the literal and material register, the term refers to physical action and resistance: force applied through the painter's body and tool, friction at the surface, the behaviour of moving water, gravity, viscosity, absorbency and the obstruction or redirection of material. These effects can be observed and, in other contexts, measured, although this essay does not assign them numerical values.

In the methodological register, pressure names accumulated conditions that bear upon making: research, memory, bodily state, the psychological effect of place and inherited art-historical conventions. No equivalence is claimed between geological force and emotion, or between hydraulic behaviour and history. The shared word identifies an operative consequence, not a common physical substance. To prevent pressure becoming an unlimited metaphor, a condition counts as methodological pressure only when it can be connected to a change in material action - pace, force, risk, scale, sequence, handling, redirection or the decision to stop. If no such consequence can be identified, it remains context rather than operative pressure.

At release, the danger is not thought itself but thought becoming a Claude glass that makes the unruly compositionally safe. Kandinsky's inner necessity and Bergson's *élan vital* offer analogies for decisions arising from internalised pressure rather than convention alone (Kandinsky, 1911; Bergson, 1911). Neither idea requires the absence of intellect; both help clarify how accumulated thought can remain active as responsive material judgement. The Abstract Expressionists offer historical precedents for whole-body painting, though not for the complete Hushing methodology. Pollock's floor-based practice involved deliberate technique, repeated judgement, gravity, viscosity and movement across the support. Within Hushing, its relevance lies not in a myth of unconscious spontaneity but in the negotiation between bodily action and material behaviour. I read Kline's enlarged black forms similarly: not as proof that thought has disappeared, but as a collision between preparation, scale, speed and decisive bodily action.

Hushing therefore engages Abstract Expressionism and process painting without renaming action painting: it relocates bodily gesture and material encounter within a researched, place-generated process. Hushing begins with place, before the first mark. Its pressure does not originate solely in the painter's interiority: the accumulated conditions of place are internalised before they enter the work. The painter's inner state is one pressure among several, not the sole source of the painting. The painter acts on material, but place, weather, material resistance and inherited history also act back.

This changes the status of gesture. A dragged brush, flooded stain or abraded passage is not required to resemble a glacier, river or scar in order to belong to Wharfedale. Because those processes have been researched, encountered and internalised, gesture can carry place through analogous material principles - pressure, resistance, abrasion, displacement, flow and deposition - rather than through pictorial likeness. Hushing also gives the gestural event a defined threshold and completion logic: First Strike, deposition and unrepaired aftermath. In this sense Hushing develops gestural abstraction specifically for the problem of responding to place and landscape.

British Abstraction and the St Ives Lineage

Any attempt to position Hushing within British abstract painting must begin by acknowledging that the movement from landscape into abstraction already has a substantial British history, nowhere more concentrated than in the post-war St Ives group. Tate describes St Ives as the setting for a major school of British abstraction associated with artists including Ben Nicholson, Peter Lanyon, Patrick Heron, Roger Hilton, Barbara Hepworth and Terry Frost (Tate, n.d.-c). Hushing therefore does not claim to invent abstract landscape; it enters an established British argument about how place can remain active when representation loosens or disappears.

Within that lineage, Peter Lanyon is the closest personal and methodological affinity. Lanyon has long been one of my favourite painters, and the wider St Ives School has been a central point of reference in my understanding of landscape and abstraction. The Courtauld describes Lanyon's ambition as a new vision of modern landscape painting capable of carrying sensory experience, and identifies his radical near-abstract paintings of West Cornwall and later gliding works as attempts to experience land, sea and air through movement rather than through a fixed prospect (Courtauld Gallery, 2015). That concern with being physically inside a landscape rather than merely looking at it has an obvious resonance with *Painting Place from the Inside*, while remaining historically and materially distinct from Hushing. Other St Ives painters establish further points of affinity without functioning as templates. Wilhelmina Barns-Graham, a prominent member of the post-war St Ives group, repeatedly moved between observed place and abstraction across a long career (Wilhelmina Barns-Graham Trust, n.d.). Roger Hilton brought energetic, increasingly improvisational handling into British abstraction and became closely associated with St Ives (Tate, n.d.-a). Patrick Heron, who moved to Zennor in 1956, played a major role in post-war British abstraction; even when his work ceased to represent the Cornish garden directly, colour, light and shape could remain a detailed response to it (Tate, n.d.-b). Together these practices demonstrate that British abstraction already possesses a serious tradition in which place can survive the disappearance of literal description.

What Hushing contributes within that lineage is an explicit account of how geographical specificity can survive abstraction. Place is not merely an optical stimulus later abstracted in the studio; knowledge of its geology, labour, history, language, weather and social experience is translated into an earned visual language, internalised as tacit knowledge and released through material action. Process can therefore carry place after resemblance has ceased to do so. The method is transferable while the style is not: each location must bring its own palette, histories, material conditions and pressures. If the same visual formula can be transported intact, the work has ceased to be place-generated.

Hushing therefore extends rather than opposes the St Ives inheritance. Lanyon remains particularly important because his work demonstrates that sensory and bodily experience can reorganise landscape painting from within. Hushing develops that question through a research-driven structure, an explicit attention to labour and class, and a theory of completion in which deposition and unrepaired aftermath replace conventional compositional finish.

The Danish painter Per Kirkeby studied geology and participated in research expeditions to Greenland before his mature career as an artist (Museum Jorn, n.d.). That sequence matters. His paintings are dense, layered and built through accumulation, partial concealment and

structural revision. I read them as a close historical affinity: not geology treated merely as subject matter, but geological knowledge internalised into pictorial structure. Kirkeby is not the origin of Hushing, and Hushing's specific sequence of impoundment, First Strike, deposition and unrepaired aftermath remains distinct.

Duration Is Not the Measure

Hushing has no prescribed working time. A painting may reach deposition after ten minutes or several hours. Clock time records only how long the event lasted; it does not determine whether the event is complete. The relevant measure is whether the energy released after the sluice opens is still finding material expression. Some releases are violent and brief; others move slowly, pool, recur, redirect and continue. A short event is not prolonged to make the work appear substantial, and a long one is not stopped because sufficient time has passed. Duration records the event; expenditure completes it.

Completion as Deposition

Within Hushing, completion is not an act of aesthetic arbitration. The painting is not stopped because it has achieved balance, harmony or a satisfactory appearance. It reaches deposition when the force released by the First Strike can no longer generate a necessary material action through the painter. Completion is therefore an exhaustion of momentum rather than the fulfilment of a compositional blueprint.

The medium is not a neutral carrier within this process but a resisting body. Viscosity, absorbency, surface texture, gravity and weather may accelerate, obstruct, redirect or deposit the mark. The painter is neither a passive conduit nor a dictator imposing order from outside the event, but an entrained participant whose judgement operates within the release. The completed painting remains as the material record and unrepaired aftermath of that encounter.

The Aesthetic of Aftermath

A hushed hillside is not left neat when the water has passed. The release exposes the mineral, but it also leaves the evidence of its passage: debris, scoured channels, undercut ground, deposits, overflows and displaced material. Hushing does not restore the land to a picturesque order after the event. It transforms the space and leaves the consequences visible. The painting must be permitted the same condition. It may appear under-resolved, incomplete, untidy, dispersed or scattered when judged against conventional expectations of finish and compositional harmony. Within Hushing, these qualities are not failures of resolution; they are part of the aesthetic. They record where energy travelled, where it pooled, where it broke through, what it exposed and what it left behind. To tidy these residues for the sake of beauty would be to conceal the action of the process and, in miniature, to return to the Picturesque impulse: converting disturbance into a pleasing view. The work ends with the aftermath intact.

Do Not Repair the Aftermath

After deposition, the question is whether a further mark continues the material encounter or merely makes the surface compositionally acceptable. To return and balance a corner, connect fragments, redistribute marks, close an empty passage or add a mark simply because the composition appears to need it is to rebuild aesthetic order after the event. It resembles a farmer rebuilding a dry-stone wall after a rush of water has broken through: in the landscape, repair restores use and organisation; in the painting, equivalent repair would erase evidence of disturbance. Retrospective organisation converts consequence into composition and disturbance into scenery, returning the painting towards the Picturesque aesthetic it was made to resist. The aftermath remains unrepaired.

River water is present as ground rather than depiction; geological time is present through material preparation and surface; labour histories are present through pressure, pace and direction rather than necessarily through figures. 'Painting Place from the Inside' names this shift: place operates as a set of geological, social, linguistic, atmospheric and material

The Frame Within the Release: Structure, Stratigraphy, Ownership and Aftermath

Hushing does not escape the history of landscape painting simply by abandoning representation. The square or rectangular support remains an inherited structure: a measured geometric field imposed upon irregular material experience. It recalls walls, windows and buildings, as well as surveyed land, field boundaries and enclosure. These associations are not fixed symbols that every painting must illustrate, but historical and structural pressures carried by the format itself.

Within conventional landscape painting, the frame has frequently operated as a window. It selects where the view begins and ends, separates the spectator from the landscape and makes place available as organised scenery. The view appears contained, stable and capable of being visually possessed. Within Hushing, the frame does not disappear, but its authority is tested. It becomes a physical boundary against which released material may gather, stop, turn or pass.

Large plaster-and-gilt frames carry an additional history. Their scale, ornament and expense can announce patronage, wealth, institutional authority and ownership. Around a landscape painting, the gilded frame may evoke the country house, estate, collector or institution through which both land and its representation became valuable possessions. The frame does more than protect the picture: it declares the cultural and financial status of the object and, indirectly, the position of its owner.

A Hushing painting may begin with an existing framed painting acquired at auction, or with a new canvas or board placed within a reclaimed frame. It may also be made without either. These are possibilities within the methodology rather than compulsory features of it. The choice remains part of the Hush.

When an existing painting is used, its image, materials, authorship, value and history become inherited conditions. The earlier work may remain visible, be partially obscured or disappear beneath the release. It is not automatically treated as worthless or selected merely to be destroyed. It becomes another material, historical and aesthetic presence to which the new painting must respond.

Hushing may also be applied to the artist's own earlier work. An existing watercolour may become the inherited landscape over which a new release takes place, allowing the artist to subject their own images, decisions and attachments to the same pressures applied elsewhere. In this context, Hushing becomes both a destructive and self-critical force. It does not treat an earlier work as a conclusion that must be protected simply because it shares the same authorship.

The process is not necessarily a repudiation of the earlier painting. It acknowledges that an artist's own work can become an inherited structure: a fixed way of seeing that may need to be tested, concealed or placed under renewed pressure. The Hush therefore acts upon the artist as well as the image. Authorship offers no exemption. The artist becomes both the maker of the inherited landscape and the force released against it.

Different forms of intervention create different relationships with the inherited image. Where oil is painted directly onto an existing canvas, the previous surface may be visibly obscured and physically altered. Yet the earlier painting does not disappear. It continues to exist as a buried material layer - a stratum within the internal archaeology of the new work.

A different condition arises when oil is applied to the glass covering an existing watercolour. Here, the inherited painting remains materially untouched. It may be concealed, interrupted or transformed from the viewer's perspective, but it retains its identity

and its aesthetic, historical and potentially commercial value behind the later intervention. The oil painting occupies the glass rather than the watercolour itself. This may involve an auction painting or one of the artist's own watercolours: in either case, the earlier image remains intact while its former visual authority is challenged.

The glass consequently becomes more than a protective covering. It is simultaneously a transparent boundary, a painting surface and an archaeological divide. The watercolour forms the preserved historical stratum; the glass forms the intervening material stratum; and the oil becomes the visible but vulnerable contemporary deposit. Two images and two moments coexist within the same framed object while remaining physically distinct.

If the oil is scraped into, the later painting cannot be lifted away and recovered intact. It must be breached or partially sacrificed to reveal the preserved image beneath. Scraping therefore becomes a form of excavation. As in archaeology, access to one layer requires an intervention into another. Revelation carries a consequence: the earlier image can be exposed only by permanently changing the later one.

The work becomes a form of stratigraphy - an accumulation of images, materials, intentions, values and moments in which each stratum alters how the others can be encountered. What appears to have been erased may instead remain concealed. Hushing determines what is visible, what is buried, what survives intact and what must be disturbed for something else to be revealed.

The glass also carries its own material history. It originates principally in silica derived from sand, transformed through intense heat into a transparent solid capable of preserving, concealing and transmitting an image. Although glass is not technically classified as a metamorphic rock, it participates conceptually in a metamorphic process: mineral matter is subjected to heat and converted into a radically different material state. The transparent boundary between the two paintings is therefore itself the product of transformation.

The mineral character of the work extends into the paint. Watercolour and oil are different systems for carrying pigment, and many traditional pigments originate in earths, stones, metals and other extracted minerals, although others are organic or synthetically manufactured. These substances are ground, processed and suspended in different binders: commonly gum arabic in watercolour and drying oil in oil paint.

The framed painting therefore contains multiple transformations of matter: mineral made into pigment, pigment made into colour, sand transformed into glass and paint deposited in successive strata. Water, earth, heat, oil and excavation are not simply metaphors imposed upon the work; they are materially embedded within it. The painting contains its own geology.

This creates a direct relationship with the historical process of hushing, in which accumulated water was released to scour the land and expose concealed mineral. Within the painting, scraping into the oil to reveal the watercolour becomes a contemporary act of excavation or prospecting. Hushing does not merely describe the painting's process. Its material ancestry is already present within the glass, pigments, binders and layered surfaces of the work.

When a reclaimed frame is used, it may be attached before the First Strike and remain present throughout the making. It then becomes part of the release and consequently part of the artwork. Paint may cross the canvas, board or glass; it may splatter, stain, breach or overflow onto the frame. The Hush is not intended to destroy the frame, but neither is the frame necessarily protected from the material event. It may contain, obstruct or redirect the flow while retaining visible evidence of its encounter with it.

These marks must arise through the release rather than being applied afterwards as decorative effects. Overflow is not required, and a visibly marked frame must not become a stylistic formula repeated to make a work appear 'hushed.' In some paintings the frame may be heavily affected; in others it may receive only a trace or remain materially untouched. The determining question is whether the mark resulted from the active encounter or was subsequently added to illustrate the theory. When genuine, the marked frame becomes part of the deposition, aftermath and aesthetic of Hushing.

Howard Hodgkin provides an important precedent within the English painting tradition for making the wooden support and frame intrinsic to the painted object. Asger Jorn's *Modifications*, made by painting directly over existing pictures, provide a further affinity with the use of inherited images and supports. Hushing acknowledges these precedents while remaining materially and conceptually distinct from both.

Where Hodgkin incorporated the frame into the painted object, Hushing exposes it to a place-generated and hydraulic release. Where Jorn painted directly and irreversibly upon inherited pictures, Hushing may preserve the earlier image intact behind a separately painted glass stratum. The existing painting is not modified solely as cultural subversion, and the frame is not painted merely to extend the composition. Both are subjected to accumulated pressure, material release and the consequences of concealment and revelation.

Working over the artist's own watercolours creates a further distinction. The intervention is no longer directed only towards an inherited cultural object or the work of an unknown painter. Hushing turns back upon its own authorship, subjecting the artist's previous judgements to renewed pressure. It becomes a method of self-interrogation in which preservation, attachment and destruction are held within the same work.

Hushing therefore introduces a structure of preserved stratigraphy. The framed work may contain different images, substances, histories and systems of value, each retaining a distinct relationship to the whole. The earlier painting may survive intact but concealed; the later painting may dominate visually while remaining vulnerable to excavation; and the frame may preserve evidence of the material event that passed across it.

The final frame ceases to operate only as an external device that contains, tidies or dignifies the painting. It remains a structure, but it may also become material caught within the release. Its geometry, ornament, previous ownership and physical resistance continue to be visible, while splashes, stains and overflows record what happened when the Hush encountered its boundary. The Hush does not seek to destroy the frame. It allows the frame to bear the marks of what occurred. The frame survives, but it does not necessarily remain untouched.

A viewer may reasonably say: 'But I cannot see Wharfedale.' That is true. Hushing does not require the painting to resemble Wharfedale. There is also an element of trust required of the viewer. To encounter a Hushing painting fully, the viewer may need temporarily to suspend inherited expectations of what a landscape painting should provide: recognisable topography, pictorial description, compositional order or a view that can be named and possessed. If Wharfedale is no longer offered principally through resemblance, the viewer must allow another form of recognition to become possible.

The response may be another question: 'But can you feel it?' This does not require the viewer to believe what the painter tells them they should feel. Quite the opposite. The viewer must

trust their own response to the work: its pressure, movement, interruption, density, exposure, resistance, calm, violence or uncertainty. Sensation alone, however, cannot verify location; geographical specificity also depends upon the documented relationship between research, material and making. The question is whether the accumulated conditions through which place entered the work remain materially present in abrasion, flow, resistance, accumulation, interruption and rest. What the viewer encounters is therefore not a representation of Wharfedale but an abstract response to knowledge and understanding of Wharfedale made through Hushing. In Hushing, place is causally rather than necessarily pictorially present: it determines the conditions through which the painting is made, even when the viewer cannot identify the location from its surface.

In this sense, the encounter may produce a second, personal Hushing - an analogical account of reception rather than a further stage of the painting methodology. The painter has accumulated knowledge and released it through material action; the viewer arrives carrying expectations, memories and assumptions about landscape and painting. If those expectations are temporarily impounded and displaced, the viewer's understanding may be released or reordered through an emotional, sensory or intellectual response. This does not complete the painting, which has already reached deposition; it may complete the encounter. Place acts upon the painter, the painter acts through material and the painting acts upon the viewer.

Landscape as a Dynamic Condition

Hushing does not understand landscape as a completed scene set in aspic. Landscape is a temporary material and cultural condition produced through continuing geological, ecological and human processes. Sedimentation, uplift, erosion, glaciation, weather, farming, mining, enclosure, settlement, labour and repair have all contributed to the condition encountered in Upper Wharfedale. Its present appearance is therefore neither an original state nor a final one. To treat the landscape as timeless scenery risks concealing the processes, conflicts and acts of labour through which it came to look as it does.

To recognise landscape as dynamic is not to endorse every intervention. Change can protect, restore, expose, damage, erase or dispossess. Preservation is itself an intervention into the trajectory of change: it selects a particular condition of the landscape as worthy of continuation. Hushing therefore does not ask simply whether landscape should change. Landscape already changes. It asks what forces are changing it, what is being preserved, what is being displaced, who benefits and what aftermath remains.

The historic hush sharpens this question. Water was impounded and released in order to strip overburden and expose or exploit mineral. The operation was purposeful rather than neutral: the mineral was treated as the valuable objective while material above and around it became something to be displaced. Yet those categories depend upon position and interest. What could represent access and value to a miner or mineral-rights holder could represent disturbance to agricultural ground, grazing, walls or water for a farmer. The distinction between mineral and overburden is therefore not only material; it can also be a distinction of value, power and use.

Within this painting case the consequences of the release are comparatively bounded: the method does not authorise the physical alteration of Wharfedale. The significance is conceptual and material within the work. The landscape is approached as a dynamic field of forces rather than a static prospect, and the painting responds to those forces without pretending that change itself is automatically good. This distinction becomes ethically more consequential if Hushing is later applied beyond painting, where a release may materially affect other people, places or interests. The landscape case therefore contains the seed of a wider question already implicit in the mining origin of the method: who defines what is valuable, what is treated as expendable, and who lives with the aftermath?

The finished work therefore carries geology, labour history and the working-class counter-claim as force rather than legible content. It neither asks to be beautiful nor offers a consumable view; it holds its ground through presence, particularity and material fact.

Once completed, the painting enters the world as a cultural object. Like a chockstone wedged in a fissure or gorge, it holds its position through particularity: the chemistry of a place, the pressure of a particular body and the political refusal of a particular inheritance. Particularity is its grip; the chockstone is load-bearing and redirects the flow around it.

What greater force may act upon it - another generation, another history, another act of dispossession or renewal - remains unknown. The painting holds the ground that landscape, people and the labour of making asked it to hold. It may survive or it may not, but it was never picturesque.

Kane Cunningham

Hushing Vernacular - Key Terms

These terms form the working vernacular of Hushing. They are not decorative labels attached to a finished style; they name distinct conditions, pressures and thresholds through which a Hushing painting is researched, begun, carried, completed and judged. Together, they provide a language for discussing abstract landscape without reducing place to pictorial resemblance: they describe how place can persist through pressure, process, material consequence and rest.

Hushing - The distinct place-generated methodology in which accumulated knowledge is released through decisive material action.

Painting Place from the Inside - The broader position of Hushing: geology, labour, history, language, weather, psychology and material behaviour participate in determining how the painting is made.

Process as Carrier of Place - In Hushing, resemblance is not the principal test of geographical specificity. Research and encounter are internalised until place persists causally through pressure, material process, gesture, consequence and rest rather than through pictorial likeness.

Earned Visual Language - A palette, set of materials, marks and processes generated through sustained encounter with a particular place rather than generic taste or predetermined style.

Dynamic Landscape Principle

Landscape is a temporary condition shaped by geological, ecological and human processes. Change is intrinsic but not automatically good; interventions are judged by what they protect, expose, displace, benefit and leave behind.

Mineral / Overburden

Historical hushing distinguishes sought value from displaced material. Hushing asks who defines the value, what is made expendable and who carries the disturbance.

Grounded Research Affinity - Hushing shares an inductive affinity with grounded research: knowledge accumulates through sustained enquiry and encounter rather than being organised around a predetermined visual conclusion. This is an affinity, not a claim that Hushing follows formal Grounded Theory procedures.

Ethnographic Affinity - Hushing shares an affinity with ethnographic enquiry through fieldwork, observation, conversation, situated encounter and reflexive awareness of the painter's own position within the research.

Phenomenological Affinity - Hushing shares an affinity with phenomenology through its recognition of bodily, sensory and lived experience as valid forms of situated knowledge. The body is not merely present in the landscape; it participates in knowing it.

Tacit Knowledge / Theoretical Support - Polanyi's account of tacit knowledge supports the transition by which accumulated research becomes internalised and capable of informing responsive material action without requiring continuous verbal or conceptual supervision.

Accumulation - The gathering of geological, historical, social, bodily, psychological and art-historical knowledge through research and encounter.

Impoundment - The condition in which accumulated knowledge is held rather than immediately illustrated. It becomes tacit pressure, analogous to water held behind a dam.

River-Ground - In the Upper Wharfedale application, water collected from the place materially conditions the support during impoundment but does not open the sluice. It is a place-specific preparatory device, not a universal requirement of Hushing.

Deep Geological Time / Trace Material - Geological duration enters through researched knowledge of the dale and through place-specific water that may carry dissolved ions, trace constituents and suspended particles from its catchment. No precise chemistry is claimed without analysis.

Pressure - A bounded term used in two registers. Material pressure refers to observable physical action and resistance. Methodological pressure refers to accumulated conditions only when they demonstrably constrain, propel or redirect a material decision; it is not presented as a measurable force.

The Five Pressures - The interacting conditions of place; the painter's body; medium and substrate; psychological state and the mood of place; and inherited landscape conventions. They are distinct in kind and linked by their observable consequences for making, not by a claim that they are physically equivalent.

The Sluice - The threshold between accumulated preparation and decisive material action.

The First Strike - The painter's first committed intervention on the prepared surface. It opens the sluice. The prior river-ground belongs to preparation, not release.

Release - The movement of accumulated pressure into action through response, resistance, momentum and material consequence rather than execution of a predetermined image.

Entrainment - The condition in which the painter becomes part of the released process and is carried, redirected, obstructed or accelerated by the event.

Conscious Judgement Within the Release - Skill, choice and awareness remain active, but judgement operates inside the unfolding encounter rather than supervising it towards a conventional finish.

Material Pressure - The agency and resistance of medium and substrate: viscosity, absorbency, drag, staining, drying, pooling, breaking and surface friction, all modified by weather.

Psychological Pressure - The painter's inner state together with the psychological effect of place. These may alter pace, risk, force, hesitation, scale or duration without becoming illustrative symbols.

Art-Historical Pressure / History as Foil - Inherited landscape traditions may provoke resistance, affinity, excitement or doubt, but cannot become a compositional supervisor after release.

Expenditure - The consumption of released energy through making. Duration is secondary: a brief painting may expend its force completely while another continues for hours.

Deposition - The point at which released force can move the painter no further, either because energy has been expended or because the process has reached material or bodily rest. A pause does not itself constitute deposition.

The Deposition Test - Three questions used to distinguish completion from preference: Is the next mark demanded by the encounter or by dissatisfaction? Has movement become repetitive, decorative or explanatory? Would another mark continue the release or begin repairing its consequences?

Duration Is Not the Measure - Elapsed time does not determine completion. The relevant measure is whether released force can still find material expression through the painter.

Aftermath - The material condition left after release and deposition: exposed ground, debris, interruptions, undercut edges, overflows, scattered deposits and empty passages.

The Aesthetic of Aftermath - The recognition that apparent incompleteness, untidiness, imbalance or dispersal can be evidence of force having acted rather than defects requiring correction.

Do Not Repair the Aftermath - Once deposition has occurred, marks are not added solely to restore conventional balance, beauty or finish. Retrospective repair converts consequence into composition and disturbance back into scenery.

Rectangular Support / Material Boundary - The canvas or sheet functions as an impoundment structure and physical limit rather than a window onto a selected view. Its edge may resist, redirect or be breached by the release. Final framing protects the deposited aftermath without repairing or mastering it.

Personal Hushing - An analogical account of the viewer's response to the completed work, in which inherited expectations of landscape representation may be suspended or reordered through a direct emotional, sensory or intellectual encounter. It is not a further stage of the painting methodology.

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